Ex No:2 Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface.

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ZOHO CREATOR FEATURES DEMONSTRATION:

Application:

The **Applications** section within Zoho Creator is the core workspace where you develop, edit, and configure custom business applications. Key features include:

- **App Creation & Dashboard:** Create new low-code applications from scratch, templates, or spreadsheets, and manage existing apps (such as the *Insurance Claim Request Form* application) from a central view.
- **Component Development:** Build and edit essential app building blocks, including form interfaces, workflow logic, custom reports, and dashboards.
- **Access Control & Publishing:** Manage permissions, user roles, and access controls for individual apps before publishing them to end users.
- **Quick Management Actions:** Easily access high-level options for each application, including quick editing, environment settings, sharing, and app duplication or deletion via the **More** menu.

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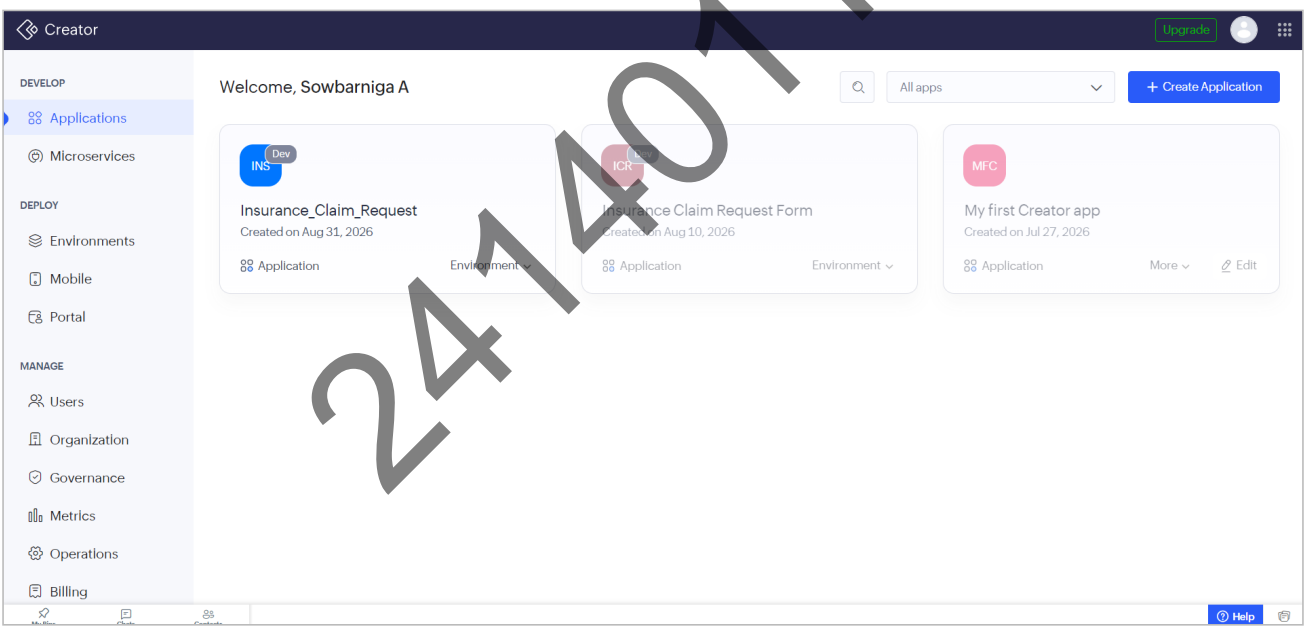


Figure: Applications page showing the Insurance Claim Request Form application

Microservices :

The **Microservices** section in Zoho Creator allows developers to build, run, and host custom backend code functions and modular APIs independently from individual low-code applications. Key features include:

- **Modular Backend Logic:** Write and run standalone code blocks (such as Java, Node.js, or Python functions) to handle complex backend processing that goes beyond standard low-code drag-and-drop workflows.

- **Reusable APIs:** Expose custom logic as HTTP endpoints/APIs that can be called and reused across multiple Zoho Creator applications or external third-party services.
- **Independent Deployment & Scaling:** Develop and maintain specialized functions separately, allowing serverless execution without overloading your main application components.
- **Integration Bridge:** Seamlessly integrate custom external libraries, complex calculations, and heavy data-processing tasks directly into your Zoho platform ecosystem.

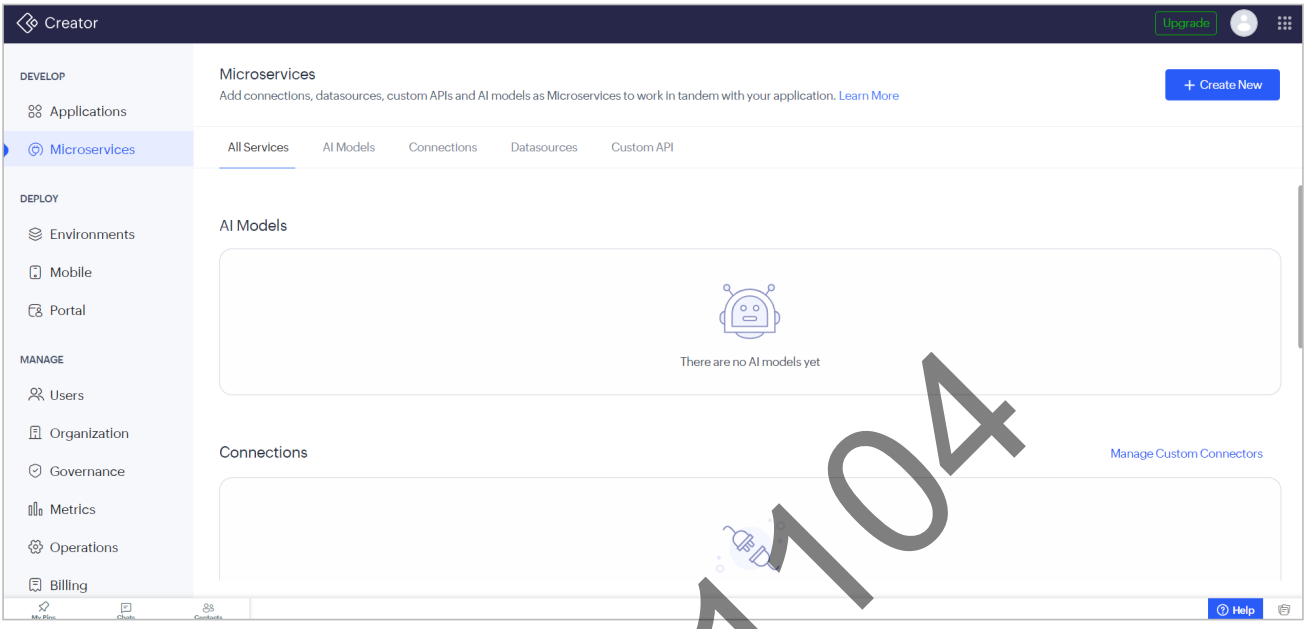


Figure: Microservices page

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Environments :

The Environment feature helps developers manage an application across different stages of development without affecting the live application.

Example

Suppose you create an Insurance Claim Request Form application in Zoho Creator.

Development → Stage → Production

You first create a new Claim Request Form in Development.

Then you test it in Stage to make sure the form and workflows work correctly.

Finally, you deploy it to Production, where policyholders and claims staff can use it.

Main advantage

The biggest benefit is safe development and deployment. Developers can work on new features and test them without disturbing the live application.

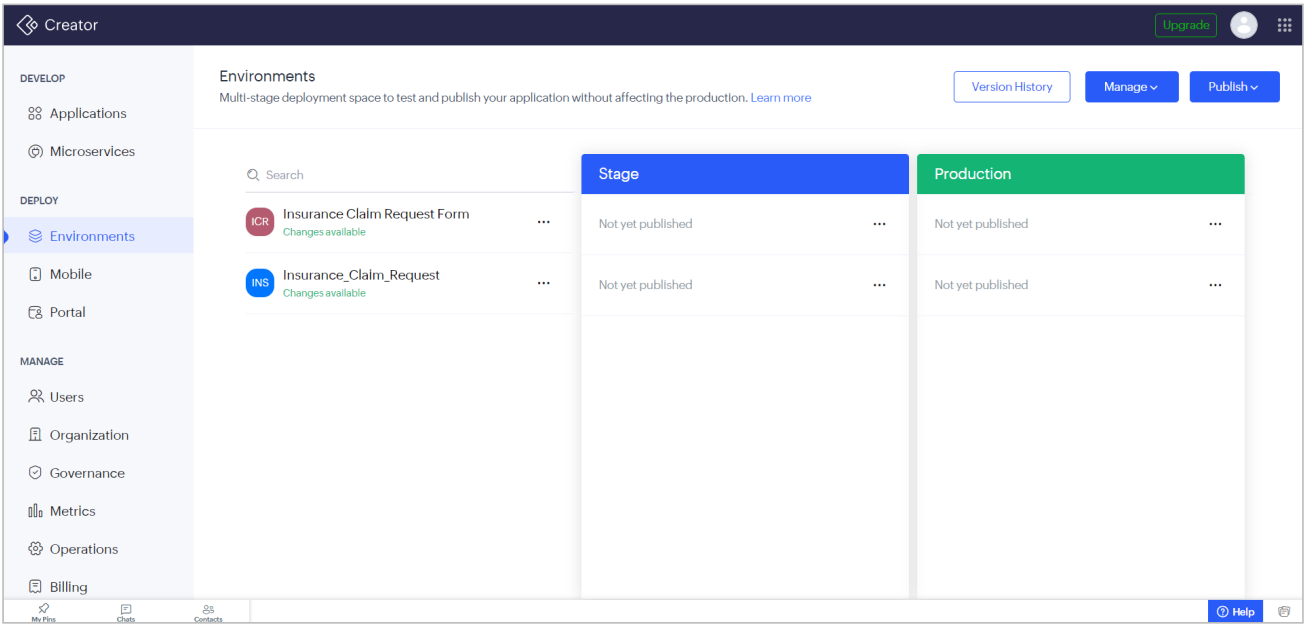


Figure: Environments page (Stage and Production)

Mobile :

The Mobile feature in Zoho Creator allows users to access and use Zoho Creator applications from mobile devices such as smartphones and tablets. It helps users work with their Creator applications anytime and anywhere using a mobile device.

Main features:

Access Applications

Users can open their Zoho Creator applications from a mobile phone or tablet.

Add and View Data

Users can fill out forms and add new records. They can also view existing data and reports.

Mobile-Friendly Interface

Applications can be used on smaller screens, making it convenient for mobile users.

Work on the Go

Employees can perform tasks while they are away from their computers. For example, a claims adjuster can update claim details while visiting a policyholder.

Access Reports and Dashboards

Users can check important information, reports, and dashboards from their mobile devices.

Use Device Features

Depending on the application and permissions, Creator apps can make use of mobile capabilities such as camera, location, and notifications. For example, a policyholder can photograph damage and attach it to a claim request.

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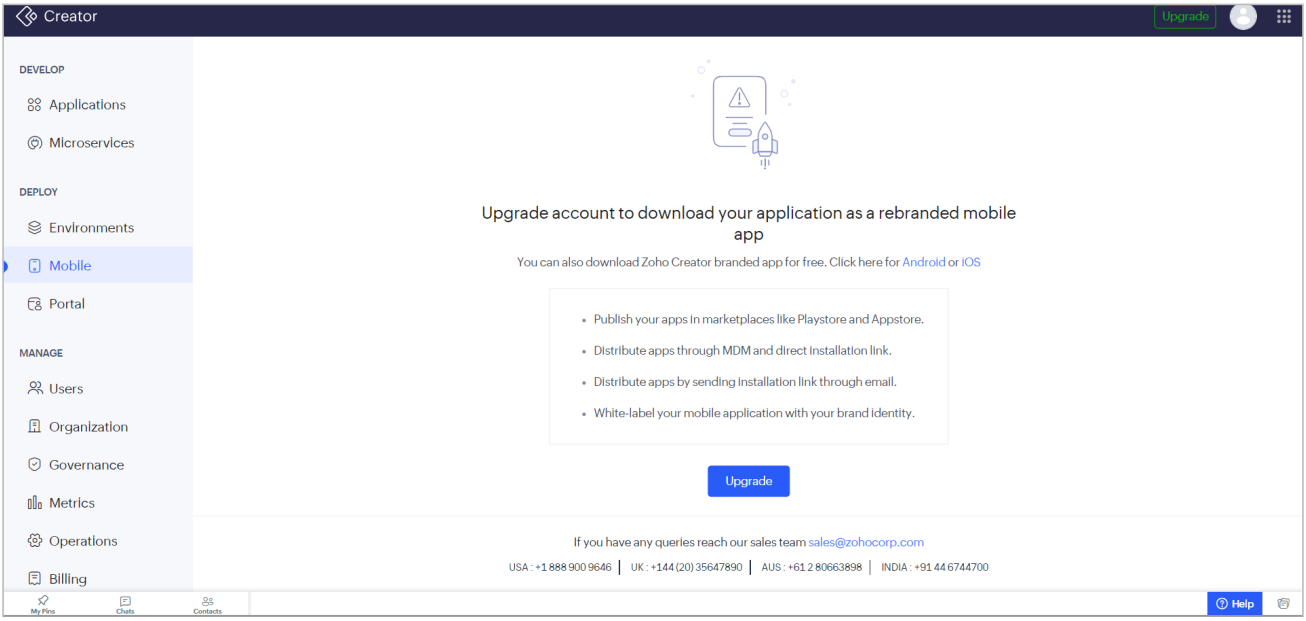


Figure: Mobile page (rebranded mobile app requires an upgraded plan)

Portal :

The Portal feature in Zoho Creator allows you to give external users such as policyholders, agents, vendors, or business partners access to your application. Instead of giving them access to your entire Zoho Creator account, you can provide them with a separate portal where they can access only the information and features you choose.

Example

Insurance Admin → Zoho Creator Application → Policyholder Portal → Policyholders

The admin manages the complete application, while policyholders use the portal to access only the features provided to them, such as submitting a claim request and tracking its status.

Main advantage

The main benefit of the Portal feature is secure external access. It allows you to connect your application with policyholders or other external users while controlling what they can see and do.

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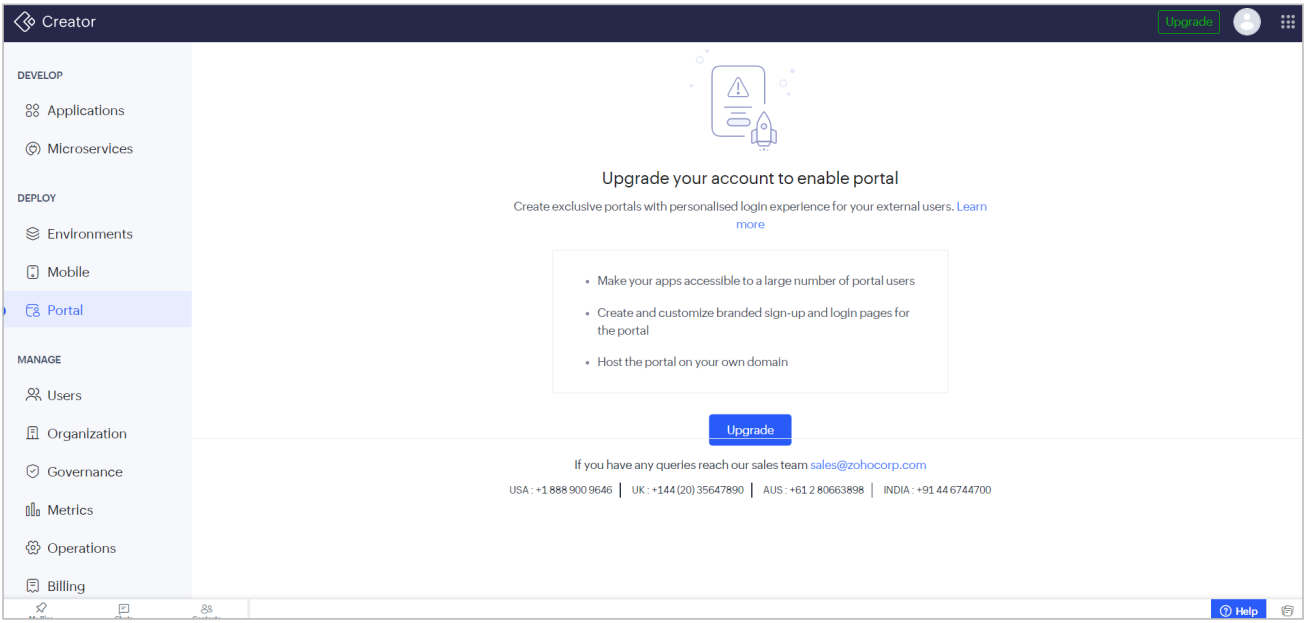


Figure: Portal page (portal creation requires an upgraded plan)

User :

The User feature in Zoho Creator is used to manage the people who can access and use your application. You can control who has access and what they are allowed to do.

Main functions

1. Add Users

You can add people who need to use your application.

2. Manage User Access

You can decide which users can access your application.

3. Assign Roles

Different users can have different roles, such as Admin, Claims Manager, or Claims Adjuster.

4. Set Permissions

You can control what each user is allowed to do.

For example, one user may only view data, while another can add, edit, or delete data.

5. Control Application Access

Users can be given access to specific applications or components based on their role and permissions.

User: Usually refers to people who are part of the organisation's application users and are given access based on roles and permissions.

Portal User: Usually refers to external users, such as policyholders, agents, or vendors, who access selected parts of the application through a portal.

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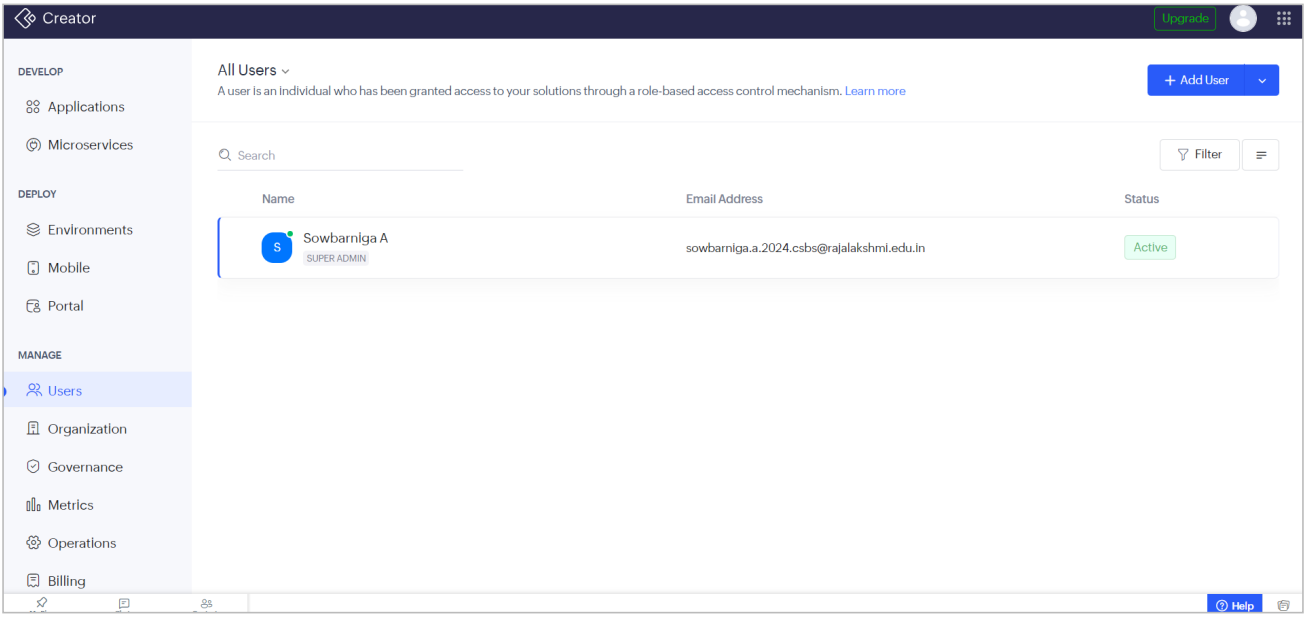


Figure: Users page (All Users list)

Organisation :

The Organisation feature in Zoho Creator is used to manage the organisation or company details associated with your Zoho Creator account and applications.

It helps you manage your organisation's setup, users, and account-related settings from a central place.

Main functions

1. Organisation Details

Manage basic information about your organisation.

2. User Management

Add or manage users who belong to your organisation. Control user access based on their roles and permissions.

3. Roles and Permissions

Define what different users can access or manage.

4. Organisation-Level Settings

Manage settings that apply to your organisation and its Creator environment.

5. Centralised Management

Administrators can manage applications, users, and organisation-related settings in one place.

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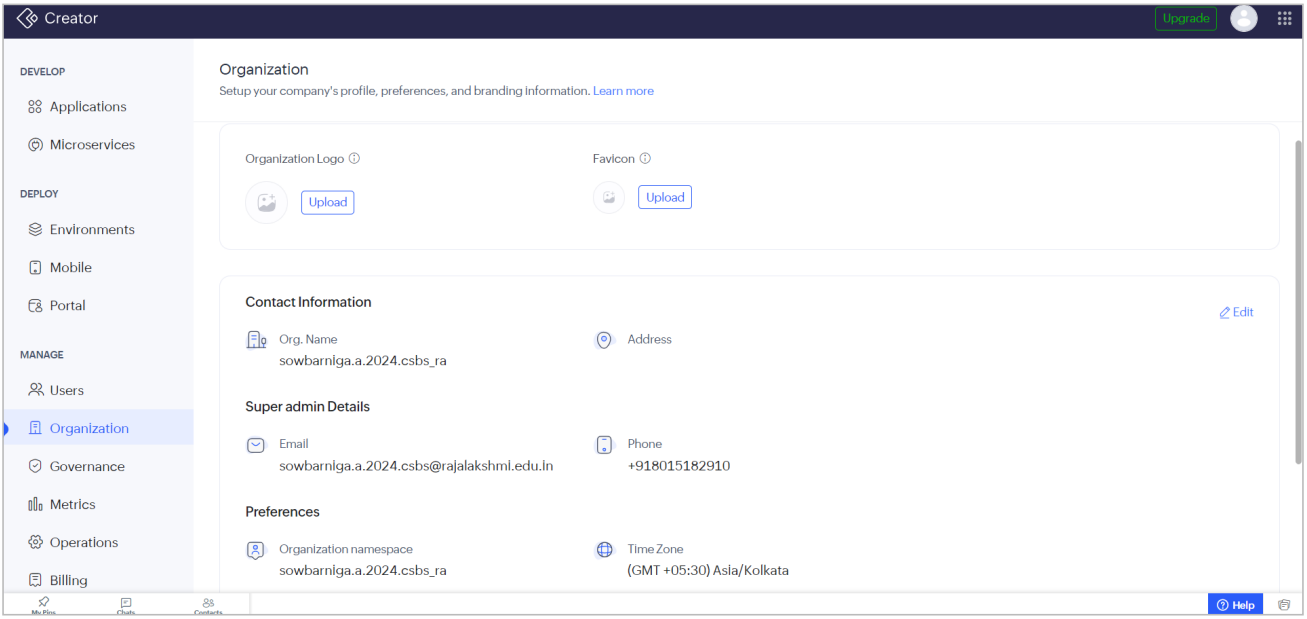


Figure: Organization page (profile, preferences and branding information)

Governance :

The Governance feature in Zoho Creator helps an organisation control, monitor, and manage how applications are developed and used. It is especially useful when many developers and teams are creating applications. It ensures that applications follow the organisation's rules, security policies, and best practices.

Main functions

1. Control Application Development

Helps organisations maintain standards when creating and managing applications.

2. Manage Users and Access

Ensures that only authorised people can access applications and perform specific actions.

3. Security and Compliance

Helps protect organisational data and maintain security requirements.

4. Monitor Applications

Administrators can keep track of applications and their usage.

5. Standardisation

Helps different teams follow common rules and guidelines while building applications.

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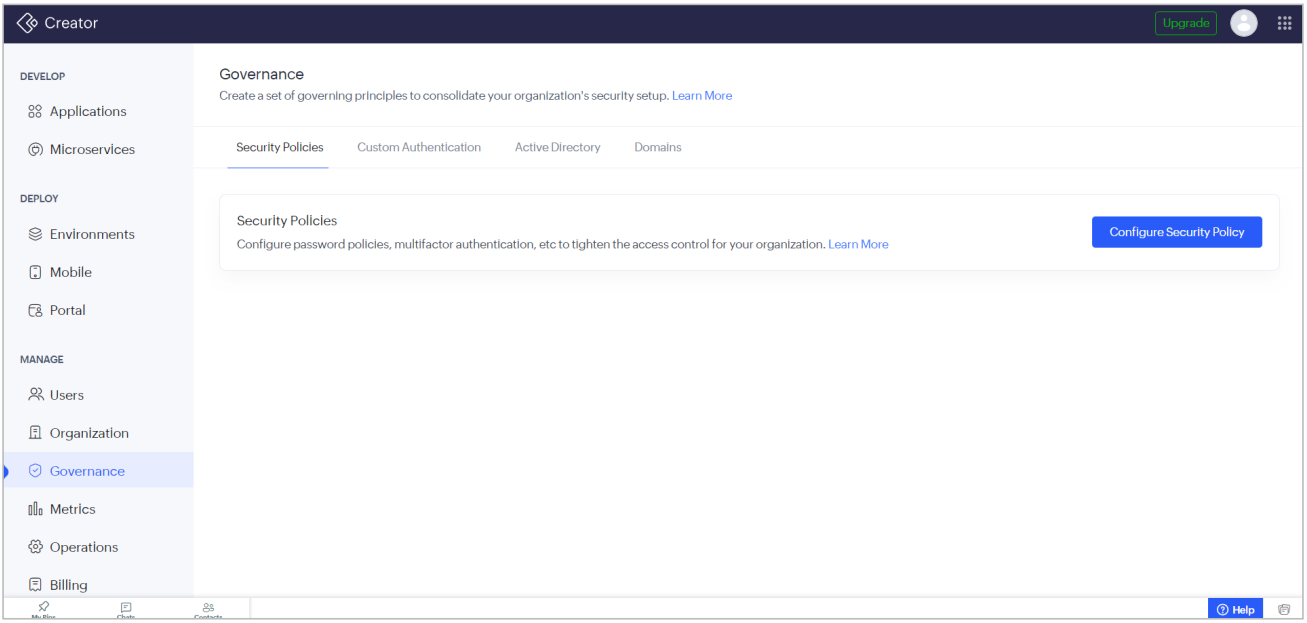


Figure: Governance page (Security Policies)

Metrics :

The Metrics feature in Zoho Creator helps you monitor and analyse the performance and usage of your applications. It gives administrators useful information about how applications are being used and how well they are performing.

Main functions

1. Monitor Application Usage

Helps you understand how frequently your applications are being used.

2. Track Performance

Helps identify performance-related issues and areas that may need improvement.

3. Analyse User Activity

Provides insights into user activity and application usage.

4. Identify Problems

Helps administrators detect unusual activity or performance issues.

5. Make Better Decisions

The collected metrics can help organisations improve their applications and manage resources effectively.

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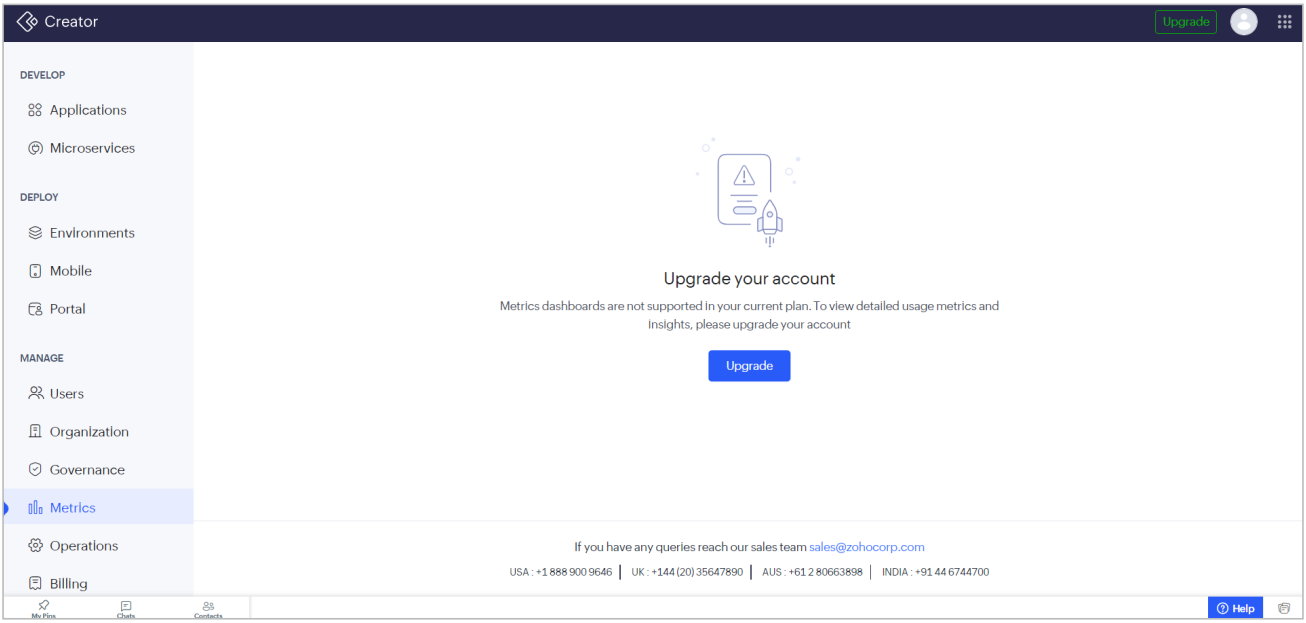


Figure: Metrics page (metrics dashboards require an upgraded plan)

Operations :

The Operations feature in Zoho Creator helps administrators and developers monitor and manage the operational activities of their applications. It provides tools to keep applications running smoothly and helps identify issues that may affect users.

Main functions

1. Monitor Applications

Helps you keep track of your applications and their operational status.

2. Monitor Performance

Helps identify performance problems that could make an application slow or affect its operation.

3. Track Errors

Helps detect errors and issues occurring in applications so they can be investigated and fixed.

4. Manage Application Operations

Provides administrators with information needed to maintain applications effectively.

5. Troubleshooting

Helps developers and administrators find problems and take corrective actions.

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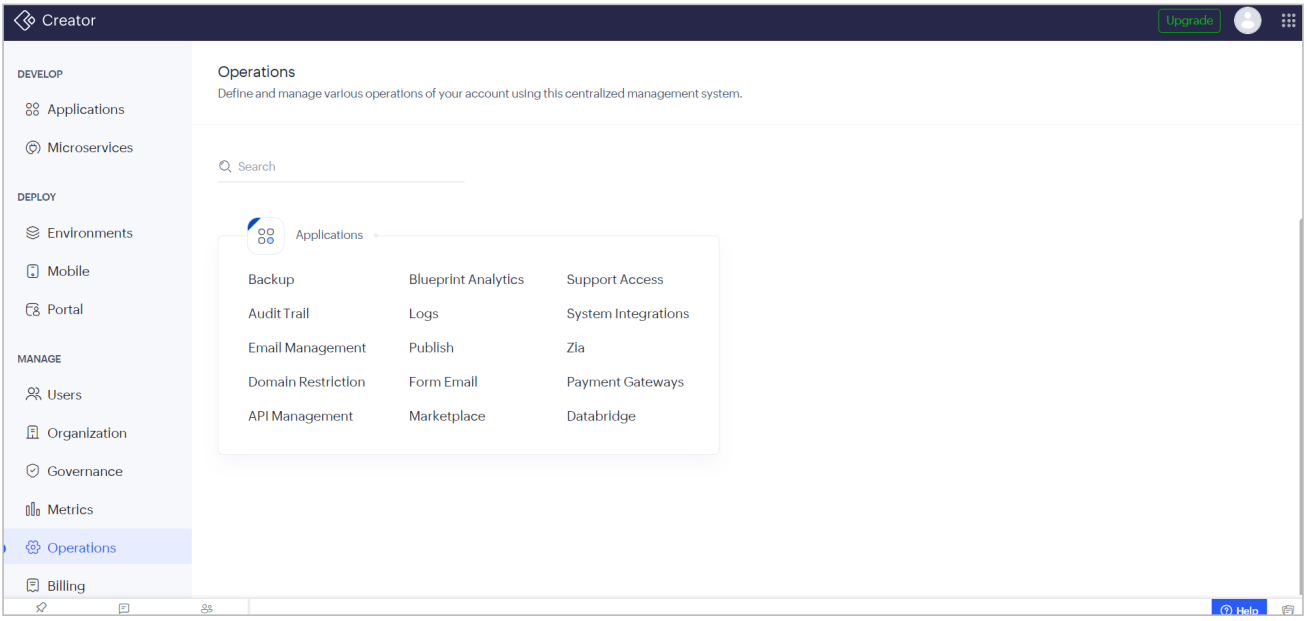


Figure: Operations page

Billing :

The Billing feature in Zoho Creator is used to manage and monitor the subscription and payment details of your Zoho Creator account or organisation.

It helps administrators keep track of their plan, billing cycle, and payment-related information.

Main functions

1. Manage Subscription

View and manage the Zoho Creator subscription plan used by your organisation.

2. Billing Information

Manage billing-related details associated with the account.

3. View Invoices

Access invoices and payment records for the subscription.

4. Payment Management

Manage payment methods and subscription payments.

5. Plan and Usage

Check information related to the current plan and usage, where applicable.

6. Upgrade or Downgrade

Change the subscription plan based on the organisation's requirements.

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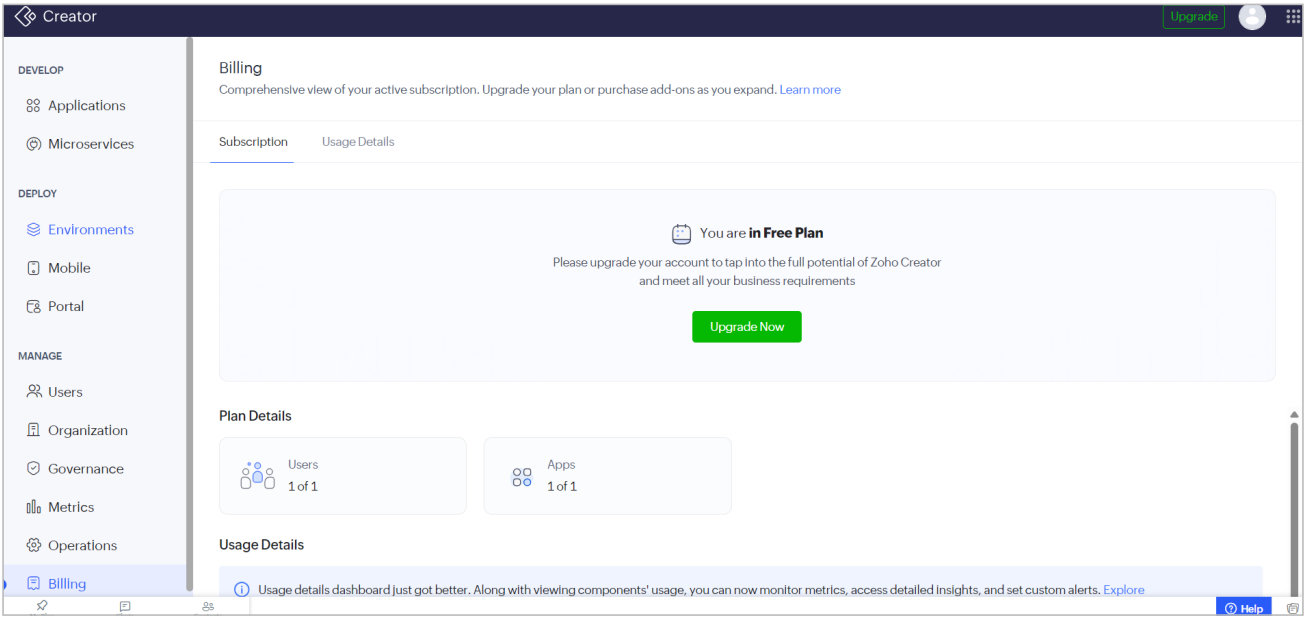
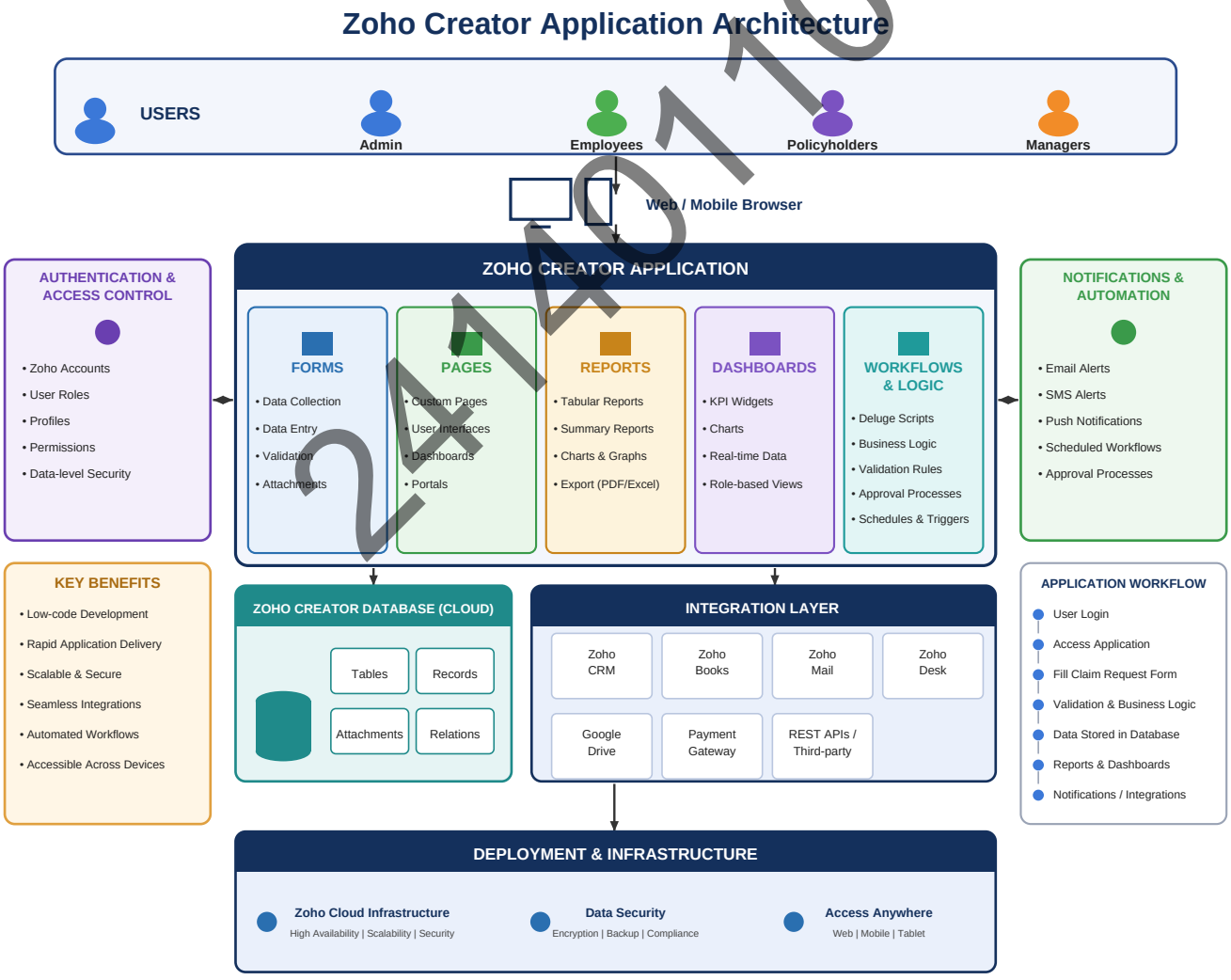


Figure: Billing page (Free Plan subscription and plan details)

Architecture Diagram of Zoho Creator :



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